Åbo Akademi

Invitation to Participate in an Expert Evaluation for Pharmacy-Counseling by Health Retrieval & Evidence-Driven Dialogue (PHRED) Framework

Information About the Study

This study aims to better understand how a digital system can support medication counselling and how users experience interacting with such a system.
The purpose of the PHRED project is to explore how digital and human-like systems can provide guidance and support about medications, with a special focus on human–robot interaction and accurate medical content.

You are participating in the role of a pharmacy expert. You will take part in a conversation with the PHRED system and assess how it delivers medication-related information and counselling.
The information collected in this study will be used to:

- Evaluate how well the system performs from an expert perspective
- Assess how closely the content of the conversation aligns with real pharmacy-based medication counselling
- Create a research dataset for future studies related to medication counselling

All data will be handled in a way that protects your identity. Results may be presented in research publications and presentations, but you will never be personally identifiable.

How the Study Is Conducted

You will:

- Take part in an online conversation with the PHRED system
- Act in the role of a pharmacy expert
- Ask questions and receive responses from the system

The conversation will be:

- Recorded
- Stored in a technical format (JSON) for research analysis

Within three days, you will be asked to complete a short questionnaire about your experience. If requested, the saved format of your conversation can also be shared with you.
The questionnaire helps us understand:

- How easy the system was to use
- How clear and accurate the information was
- How helpful you find the interaction

Total time commitment:

- Conversation: approximately 10–20 minutes
- Questionnaire: approximately 10–15 minutes

Who Can Participate?

The ideal participant is:

- An experienced pharmacist, or
- A person with professional experience in pharmacy and medicines
- A person who has studied medicine or related studies in the pharmacy domain, who in this study, is regarded as the secondary users.

You **do not need**:

- Any technical background
- Any prior experience with digital systems or robots

What Happens to the Information You Provide?

- The recorded conversation and questionnaire responses are stored securely on Åbo Akademi's server.
- No personal information is intentionally collected.
- If personal information appears by mistake, it will be removed or pseudonymised.
- Your name, face, voice, or identity will never appear in any publication.
- If data is shared with other researchers, the same strict security and privacy standards will apply.

Voluntary Participation

Your participation is completely voluntary.
You may:

- Stop the study at any time
- Choose not to answer any question
- Withdraw your participation without giving a reason

If you choose to withdraw:

- Your data will be deleted and there will be no negative consequences

By saying "Yes" during the recorded meeting, you confirm that:

- You understand what the study involves
- You agree to participate
- You agree that your anonymous data may be used for research

If you are interested in participating, please contact Prashani Jayasingha via email: prashani.jayasinghaarachchige@abo.fi.

If you have any questions about the study, you are welcome to contact us.

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